

Target Company Research Methodology & Key Insights

1. Research Sources & Tools

My research process started with building a broad list of industrial companies and then gradually narrowing it down through multiple verification stages. Instead of relying on a single source, I used a triangulation approach where every company was validated through financial, technical, and leadership-based checks.

For the initial discovery stage, I used platforms like [Justdial](#) and [Google Maps](#) to identify companies operating in Chennai's major industrial zones such as Guindy, Ambattur, and SIPCOT. These sources helped in finding manufacturers and industrial firms with an active physical presence.

To verify company size, ownership structure, and financial credibility, I used [Tofler](#) and [Zauba Corp](#). This step was important to confirm that the companies were independently managed Indian firms and not subsidiaries of multinational corporations or large conglomerates. Companies outside the ₹50Cr–₹500Cr revenue range were also filtered out at this stage.

For technical validation, I used AI tools such as [Gemini](#) and [Claude](#) to analyze technical information, manufacturing capabilities, product differentiation, patents, and R&D activities. These tools helped simplify complex technical documents and identify whether the company had genuine innovation capabilities.

Finally, I used the [DSIR Directory](#) and [LinkedIn](#) for final verification. DSIR helped confirm the existence of recognized in-house R&D facilities, while LinkedIn was useful in understanding promoter backgrounds, leadership involvement, and whether the founders had strong technical or engineering expertise.

2. Step-by-Step Research Process

Step 1: Initial Company Discovery

The first stage focused on collecting a wide list of companies from industrial directories, Justdial, and local manufacturing clusters. I mainly targeted firms operating in Specialty Chemicals and Industrial Instrumentation sectors because these segments showed strong technical depth and manufacturing relevance in Chennai.

At this stage, the priority was breadth rather than accuracy, since many companies initially appeared promising but were later filtered out during deeper verification.

Step 2: Ownership and Financial Screening

After collecting the raw list, I cross-verified each company using Tofler and Zauba Corp. The goal here was to identify firms that were truly independent businesses rather than subsidiaries of large corporate groups or multinational companies.

I also checked estimated revenue ranges to ensure the companies matched the assignment criteria of approximately ₹50Cr–₹500Cr turnover. This filtering stage significantly reduced the list and helped focus only on mid-sized firms with growth potential.

Step 3: Technical and Innovation Assessment

Once the shortlisted companies were identified, I evaluated their technical strength and innovation capability. Instead of relying only on website claims or promotional material, I looked for measurable evidence of technical depth and manufacturing capability. I searched for actual evidence of engineering depth and scientific capability.

Some of the key indicators considered were:

- Presence of patents or proprietary processes
- DSIR-recognized R&D facilities
- Specialized manufacturing techniques
- Niche or high-value industrial products
- Ability to replace commodity processes with technically differentiated solutions
- AI tools like Gemini and Claude helped analyze technical descriptions, research papers, and manufacturing information more efficiently.

Step 4: Founder and Leadership Analysis

In the final stage, I studied the promoters and leadership teams using LinkedIn and company websites. I specifically looked for founders or key decision-makers with engineering, scientific, or technical backgrounds.

This step helped identify companies where leadership was directly involved in product innovation and industrial problem-solving rather than being purely finance or operations driven.

3. Key Learnings About the Segment

Strong Technical Companies Often Have Low Public Visibility

One interesting observation was that many technically strong industrial companies have very limited online branding or outdated websites. However, despite minimal marketing presence,

several firms demonstrated highly advanced manufacturing capabilities and deep domain expertise.

Mid-Sized Firms Are at a Growth Transition Stage

Many companies in the ₹100Cr–₹300Cr range appear to have already mastered product development and technical execution. Their next major challenge is organizational scaling, process standardization, and expanding operations efficiently to reach the next level of growth.

Chennai Has a Strong Industrial Ecosystem for Instrumentation

Chennai's automotive, electronics, and power-sector ecosystem creates a strong environment for instrumentation and industrial technology companies. The local supply chain and industrial demand allow specialized firms to build deep technical expertise and long-term customer relationships.

Independent Companies Move Faster in Niche Innovation

One major challenge during the research process was that many technically strong SMEs had very limited public information available online. In several cases, technical capability had to be inferred through product catalogs, export activity, certifications, and founder background analysis rather than polished company websites.

Compared to large multinational subsidiaries, many independent promoter-led firms appeared more flexible and faster in adopting niche technologies or specialized manufacturing approaches. Their decision-making process is often quicker, allowing them to experiment and innovate more effectively in focused industrial segments.

Overall, the research process highlighted that identifying high-quality industrial companies requires much deeper investigation than standard internet searches. Financial data, technical evidence, leadership quality, and manufacturing specialization together provided a more reliable way to identify strong ICP-fit companies.